Evalu8 Compass

How to use Evalu8 Compass

A step-by-step guide to self-evaluation, staff workshops, action planning and reports, for Ofsted's renewed school inspection framework.

- For headteachers and senior leaders
- For workshop facilitators
- With a one-page sheet for staff (section 10)

evalu8compass.app · support@evalu8compass.app · Guide updated October 2026
Evalu8 Compass is independent and not affiliated with Ofsted or the Department for Education.

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The cycle in one picture

WHEN	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU GET
Start of year	Enter your school's details, upload your latest Ofsted report, then rate the checklist with evidence notes	An honest picture, area by area
A staff meeting	Staff rate the same lines anonymously in a workshop	Where staff agree, differ, or see it differently from leaders
That week	Agree ratings, add your Ofsted report and context, generate the plan	Four priorities for the term, compliance checks and a message for staff
Through the term	Track actions: owners, deadlines, progress	An action plan governors can follow
End of term	Save a snapshot, then compare next term	Evidence of what has improved

SECTION 1

What Evalu8 Compass is for

Evalu8 Compass helps leaders and staff answer one question honestly: **how well are we doing?**

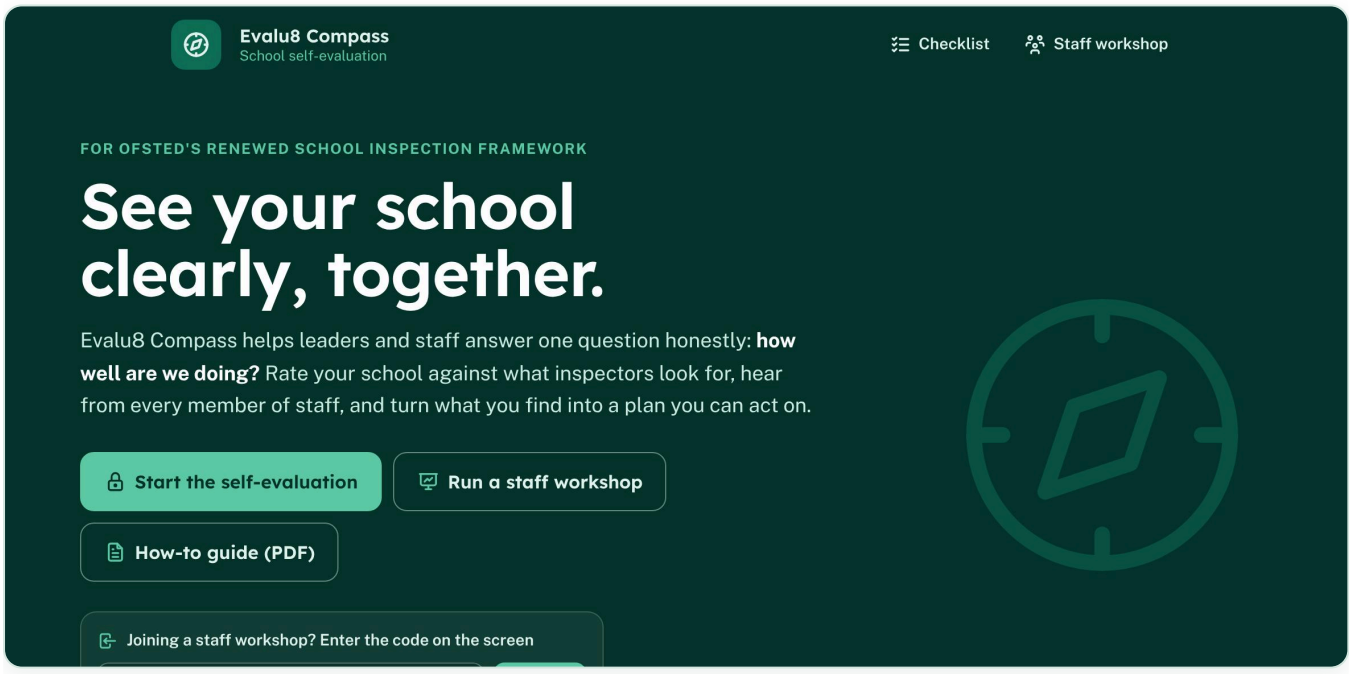
It sets out what inspectors look for under Ofsted's renewed school inspection framework, matched to your school's type (maintained, academy or independent), your phases (EYFS to post-16) and any specialist provision. You rate each expectation, record your evidence, hear from every member of staff, and turn what you find into a plan you can act on.

Built for co-creation

Self-evaluation is strongest when it is shared. Leaders rate the school, staff rate the same expectations anonymously, and the differences become the most useful conversations.

AI is your choice

Everything works without AI. If you switch it on, an AI "inspector" suggests improvement ideas and drafts plans. It only runs when you press an AI button, and it never changes your ratings.

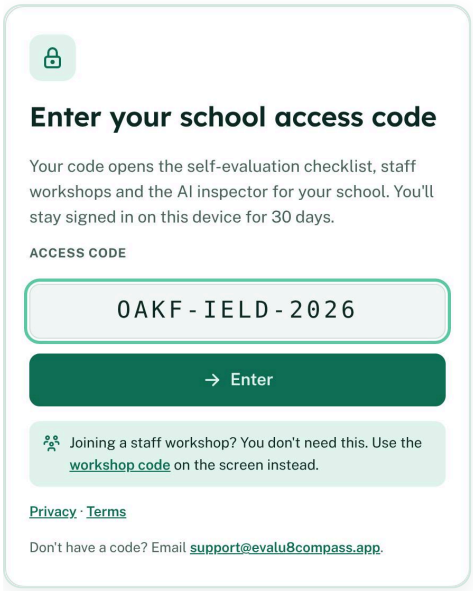


The home page at evalu8compass.app. Leaders enter from here; staff join a workshop from the box on the left.

Advisory, not a judgement. Ratings are your own, and AI suggestions are advice. Nothing in Evalu8 Compass is an Ofsted judgement or predicts one. Always check current guidance: requirements change.

SECTION 2

Getting started: your access code



Entering your school's access code.

Your school is given one **access code**, in the form **ABCD-EFGH-JKLM**. It opens your school's checklist, action plan, progress, reports and workshops.

1. Go to **evalu8compass.app** and choose **Start the self-evaluation**.
2. Type your access code (capitals and dashes don't matter) and choose **Enter**.
3. You stay signed in on that device for 30 days. Use **Sign out** in the top bar on a shared computer.

One copy for your whole team

Everything is saved to your school's account. Everyone who signs in with your code sees and edits **the same copy**, on any device. Two people can work at once: changes to different lines are kept, and colleagues' changes appear within about 20 seconds.

The badge at the top of the checklist shows whether your work is saved: **Saved to your school's account**, **Saving…**, or **Offline: saved on this device**. If the connection drops, keep working; changes are sent when it comes back.

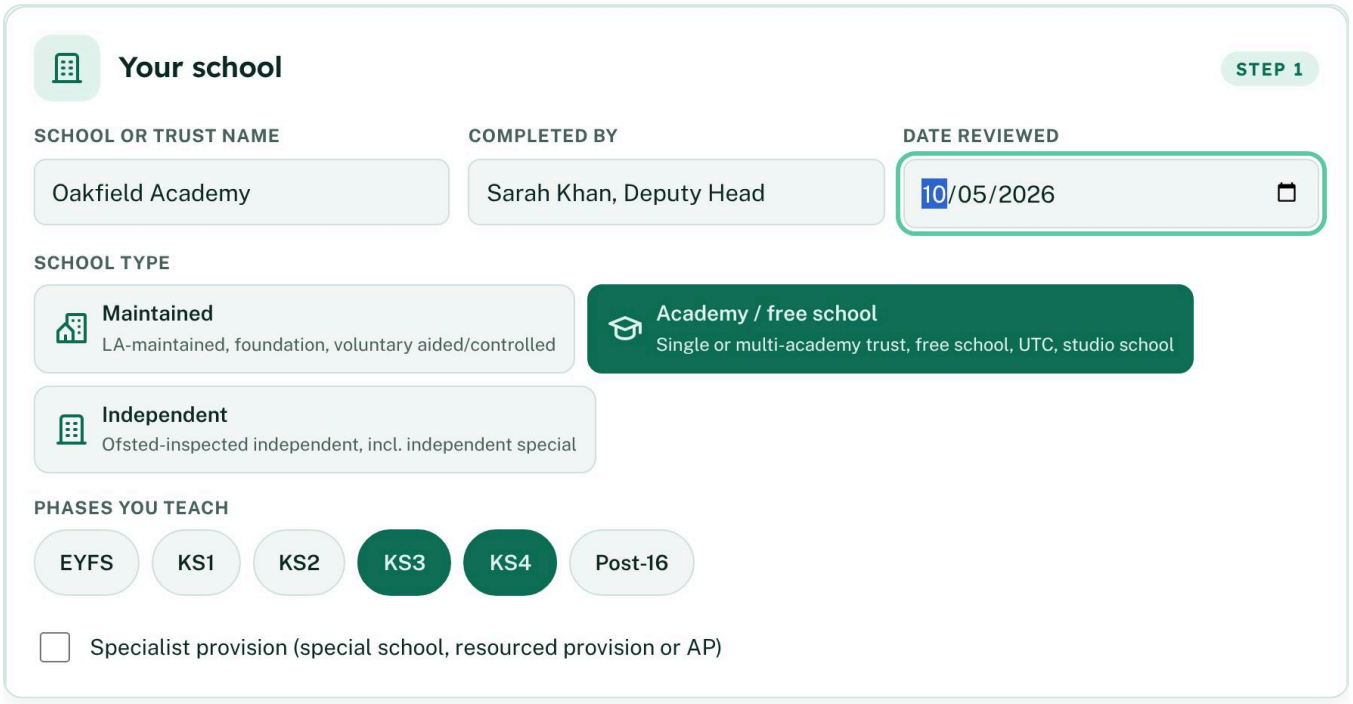
Treat the code like a password. Share it only with the leaders who need it. If it is passed on by mistake, email support@evalu8compass.app: we'll replace it straight away and your work is kept.

Staff never need the code. They join workshops with a separate 6-character workshop code.

SECTION 3

Set up your school

Do this once. It decides which expectations you see.



The **Your school** panel at the top of the checklist.

SETTING	WHAT IT DOES
School or trust name, **Completed by**, **Date reviewed**	Shown on your reports.
School type	Maintained, academy / free school, or independent. Statutory references change to match (for example the independent school standards).
Phases you teach	EYFS, KS1–KS4, post-16. Early years and post-16 areas only appear if you choose them.
Specialist provision	Adds lines for special schools, resourced provision and AP.
Use AI suggestions	On or off for your whole school. When off, nothing is sent to the AI and AI buttons are hidden. Your monthly AI allowance is shown just below.
Add school logo	Appears in the top bar and on reports (PNG, JPG or SVG, under 200 KB).

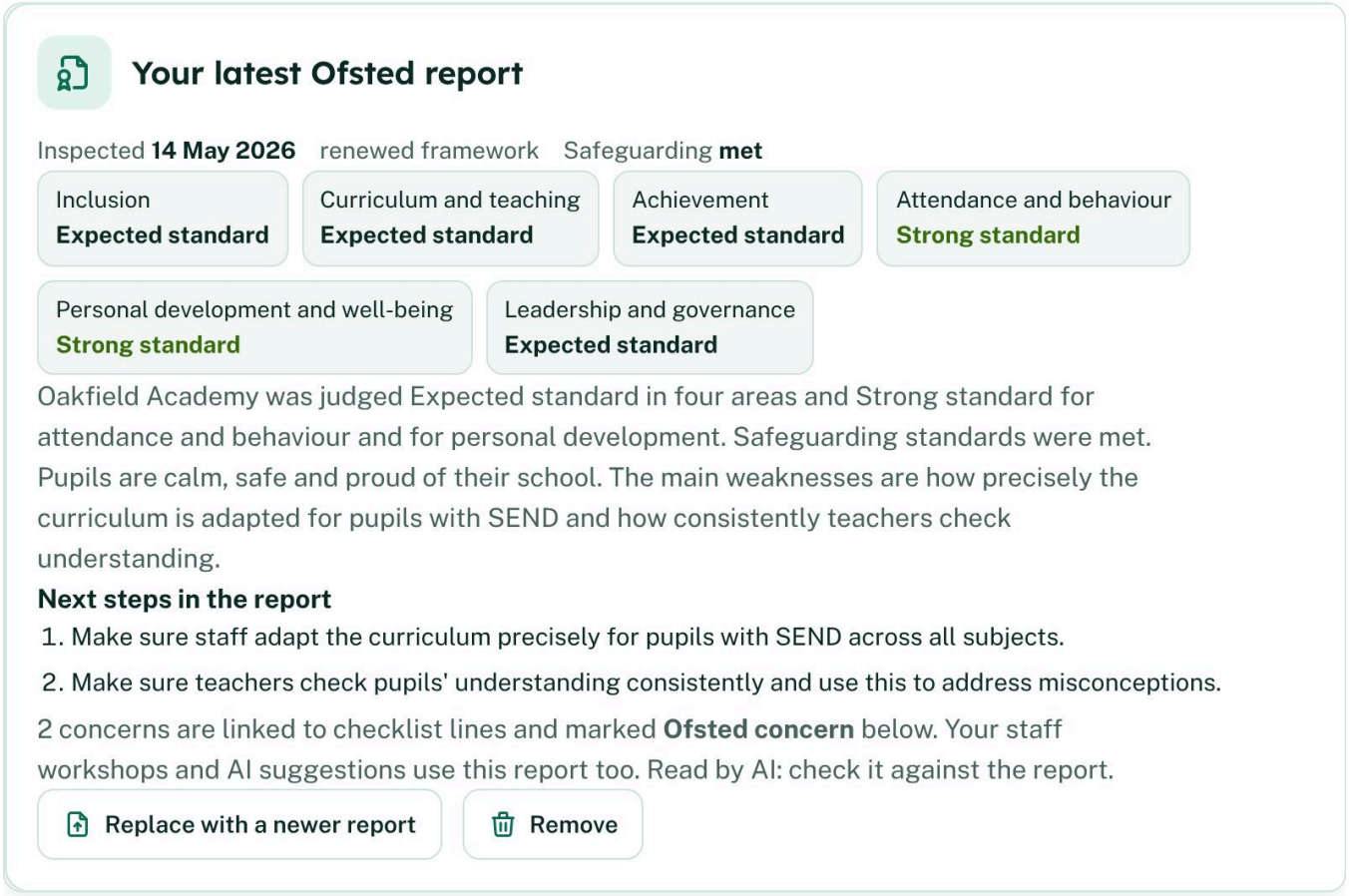
Changing your type or phases never loses answers: lines you hide keep their ratings, and come back if you change your mind.

SECTION 3 CONTINUED

Step 2: upload your latest Ofsted report

Straight after your school's details, upload your most recent Ofsted report. Choose **Choose PDF** (or paste the report's text), then **Read the report**. The AI reads it once and saves:

- the inspection date, the framework, the safeguarding outcome and each area's grade;
- the report's next steps, in order;
- which checklist lines the report raised. These lines are marked **Ofsted concern** (or **Ofsted strength**) in the checklist.



Step 2 after the report has been read. Use **Replace with a newer report** after your next inspection.

You only do this once. The AI inspector's advice and readiness review take the report into account, it appears in your self-evaluation report, and every staff workshop you start offers to use it.

New independent schools

If your school is independent and hasn't yet had its first standard inspection, tick **New school** in Step 1 and enter the month you opened. Then:

- In Step 2, upload your **pre-registration inspection report**. The AI reads which standards were judged likely or unlikely to be met, and flags anything unlikely to be met on your checklist.
- A **Ready for your first standard inspection?** panel lists what must be up and running, in order: before pupils start, the first half-term, by the end of the first term, and before the inspection. Each item shows its status from your ratings, with the standard it comes from.

- **First inspection readiness** gives an AI evaluation against each part of the independent school standards, four priorities, and the evidence of implementation to build up. Your first standard inspection comes within your first year of operation.

> ⚠ The reading is done by AI. Check the grades and next steps against your report. Reading it uses one AI request and needs AI suggestions switched on in Step 1. No report yet, for example a new school? Skip this step.

SECTION 4

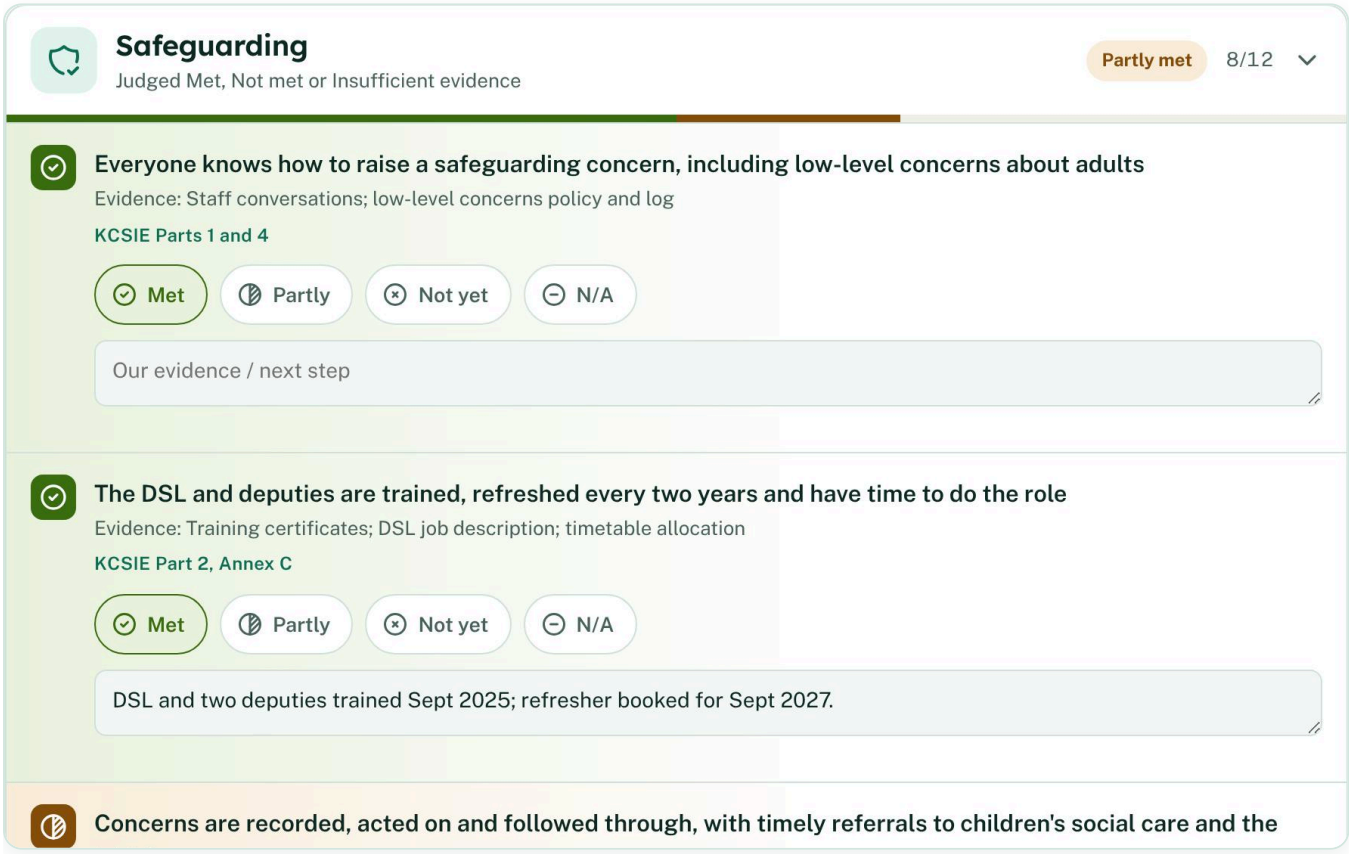
Rate the checklist

Each evaluation area lists what inspectors look for. Rate every line and note your evidence.

RATING	USE IT WHEN
Met	You can evidence it consistently, across the school.
Partly	It's in place but not consistent, or not yet embedded.
Not yet	It's a gap.
N/A	It genuinely doesn't apply to your school.

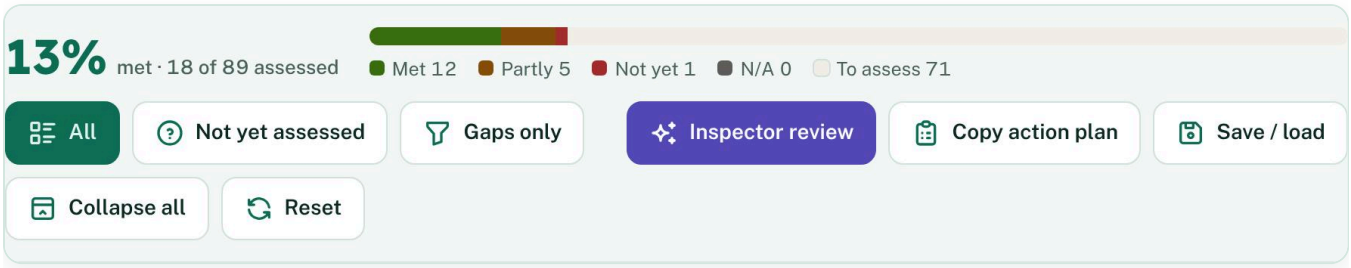
Be honest, and evidence-led. "Partly" with a clear note is more useful than a generous "Met". Inspectors will test what you say.

Keep names out of notes. Describe what happens, not who: "some subject staff log concerns late", not a colleague's name. Never record information about individual pupils.



Rating lines in Safeguarding, with evidence notes. Each line shows the evidence inspectors look for and the statutory reference.

Useful tools



The summary bar: overall % met, a breakdown, and tools.

- **Not yet assessed** and **Gaps only** filter the list.
- **Collapse all** folds the areas so you can work one at a time.
- **Save / load** copies your whole self-evaluation as text, as an extra backup.

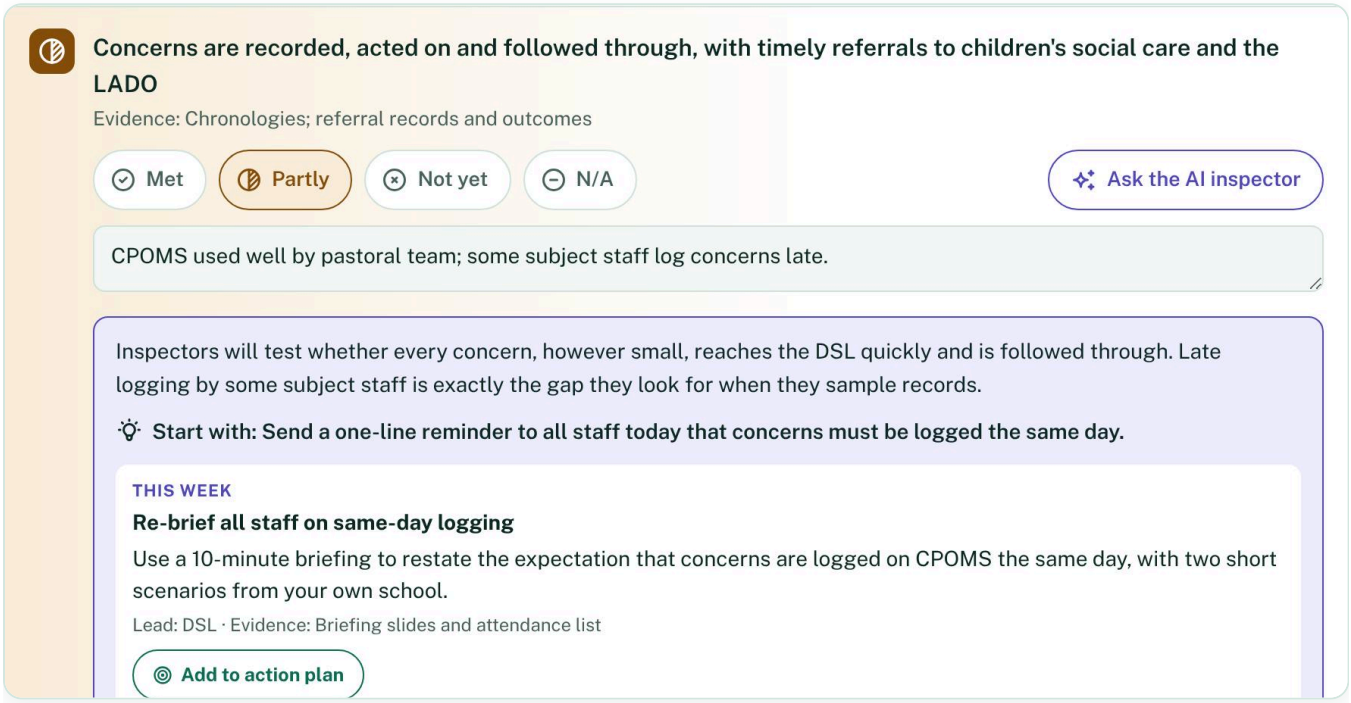
SECTION 5

The AI inspector (optional)

Two kinds of help, both advisory. Use them only if your school has AI switched on.

Ideas for one line

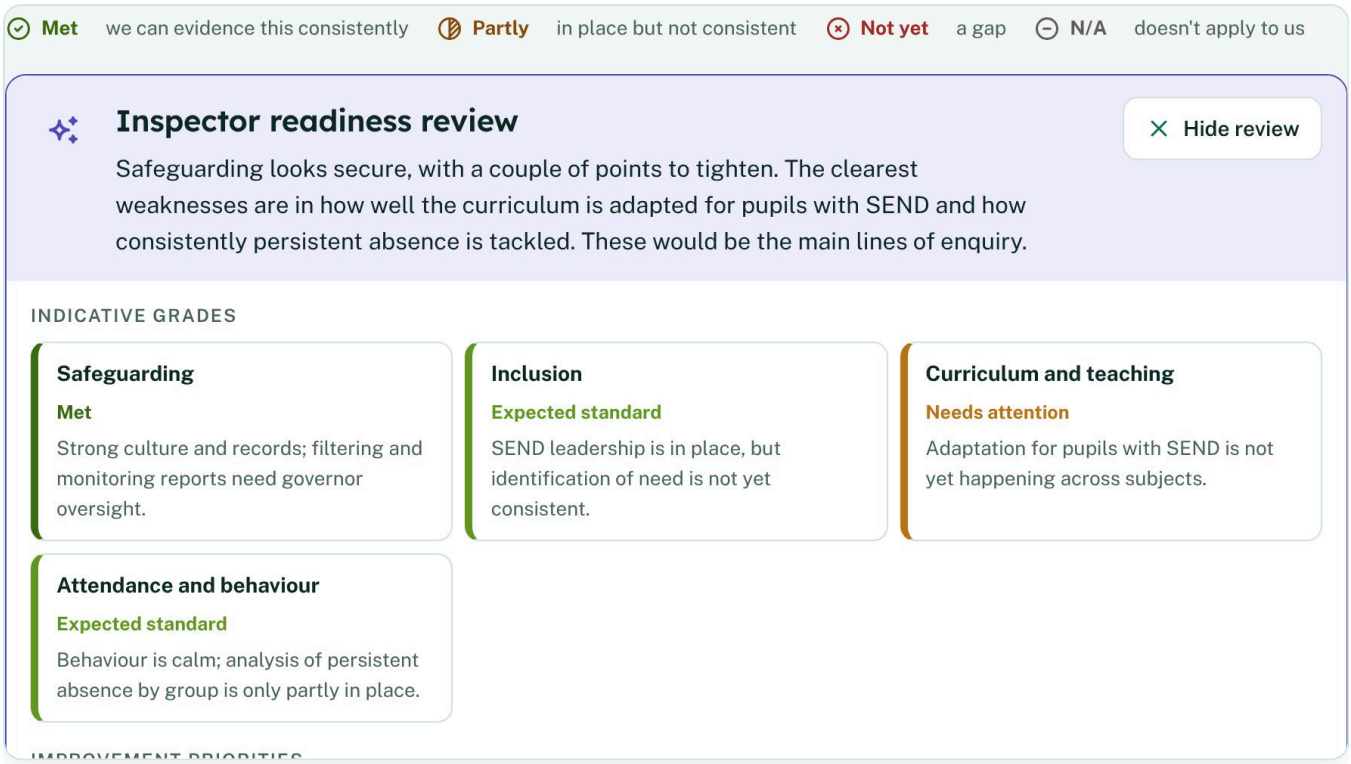
Rate a line Partly or Not yet and choose **Ask the AI inspector**. You get 3–4 activities ordered from quickest to longest, each with a lead, a timescale and the evidence it will produce, plus the question an inspector is likely to ask. Choose **Add to action plan** on any activity you want to keep.



Example advice for a line rated Partly. (Examples in this guide are from a made-up school, Oakfield Academy.)

Inspector review of the whole checklist

Choose Inspector review for indicative grades for each area, four priorities for the coming term, strengths to showcase, and a separate list of **compliance checks** (policies or statutory items to fix now).



An inspector readiness review. Grades are indicative only.

Monthly allowance. Each school has a monthly allowance of AI requests, shown under the AI switch. If it runs out, you'll see built-in suggestions until it resets on the 1st of the month. Everything else keeps working.

SECTION 6

Build your action plan

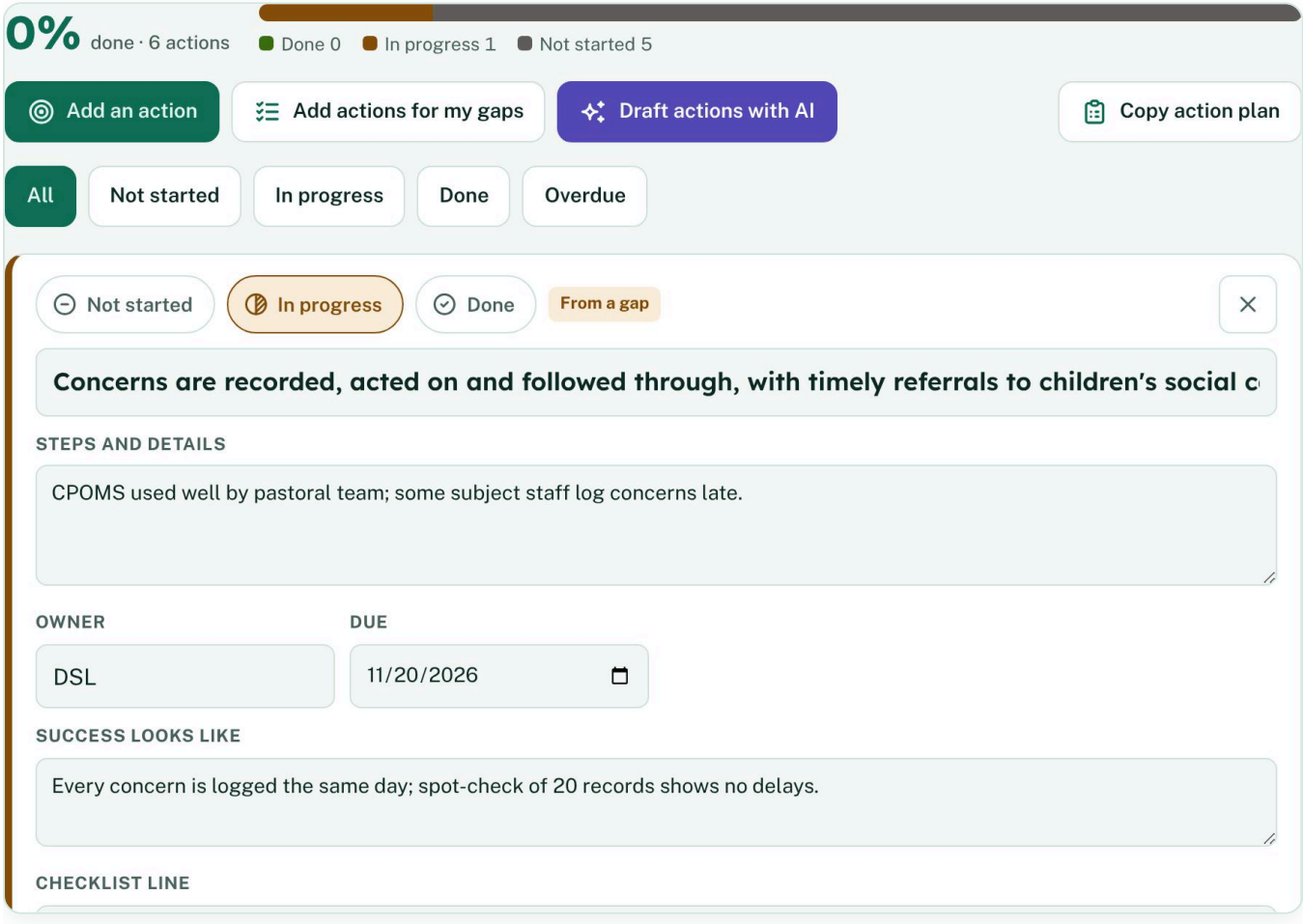
Open the **Action plan** tab. Every action has an owner, a deadline and what success looks like.

Three ways to add actions

- Add an action to write your own.
- Add actions for my gaps creates one for every line rated Partly or Not yet.
- Draft actions with AI drafts a plan from your gaps for you to edit.

Keep it moving

- Set each action to **Not started**, **In progress** or **Done**.
- Overdue actions are flagged. Use the **Overdue** filter before a leadership meeting.
- Link an action to a checklist line so reports show them together.



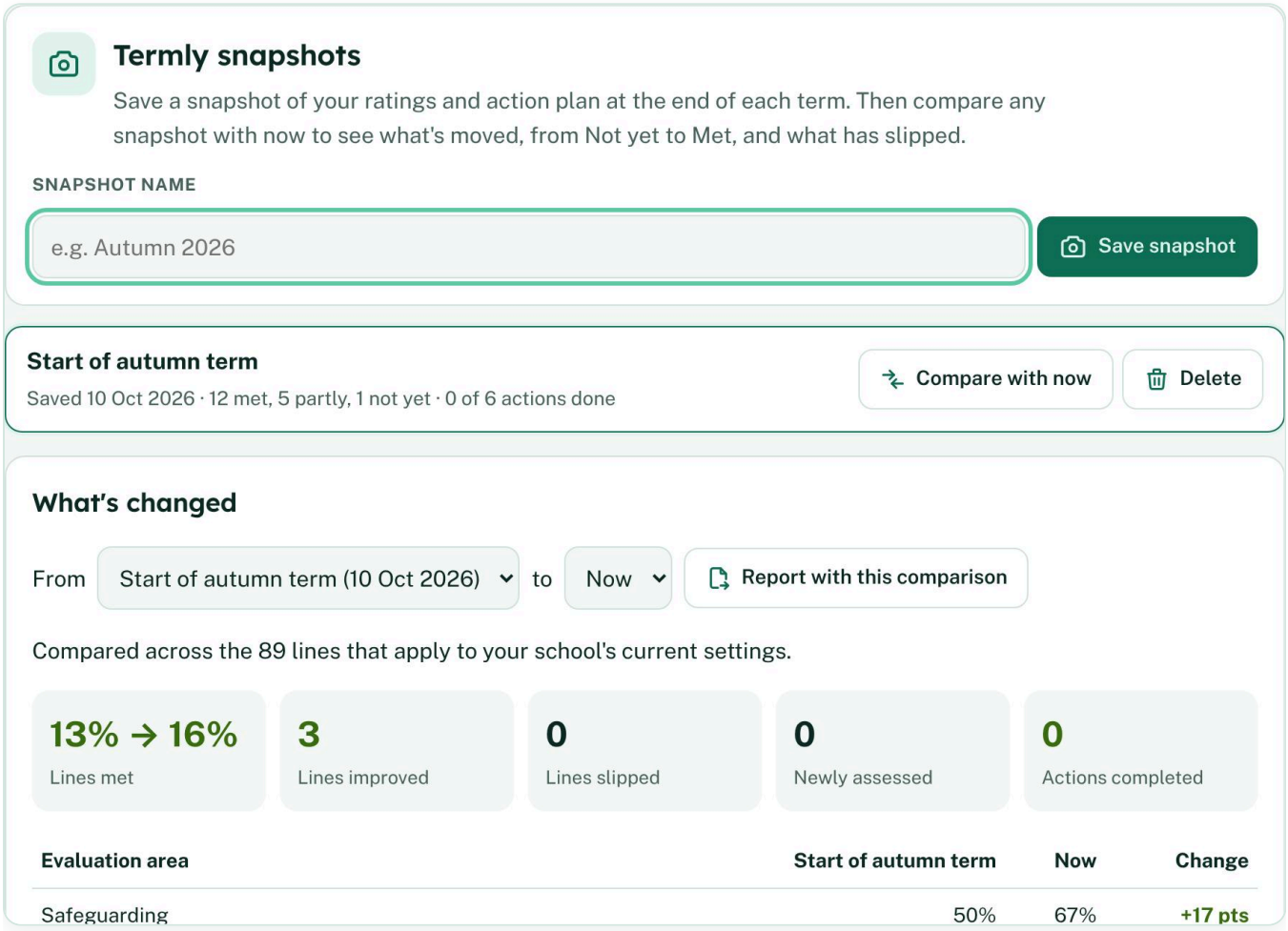
The action plan, with progress at the top.

SECTION 7

Termly snapshots and progress

Capture where you are at the end of each term, then show what has changed.

1. Open the **Progress** tab. The snapshot name is suggested from the term (for example "Autumn 2026"); change it if you like.
2. Choose **Save snapshot**. Your ratings and action plan are copied as they are today.
3. Next term, choose **Compare with now** on that snapshot, or pick any two snapshots to compare.



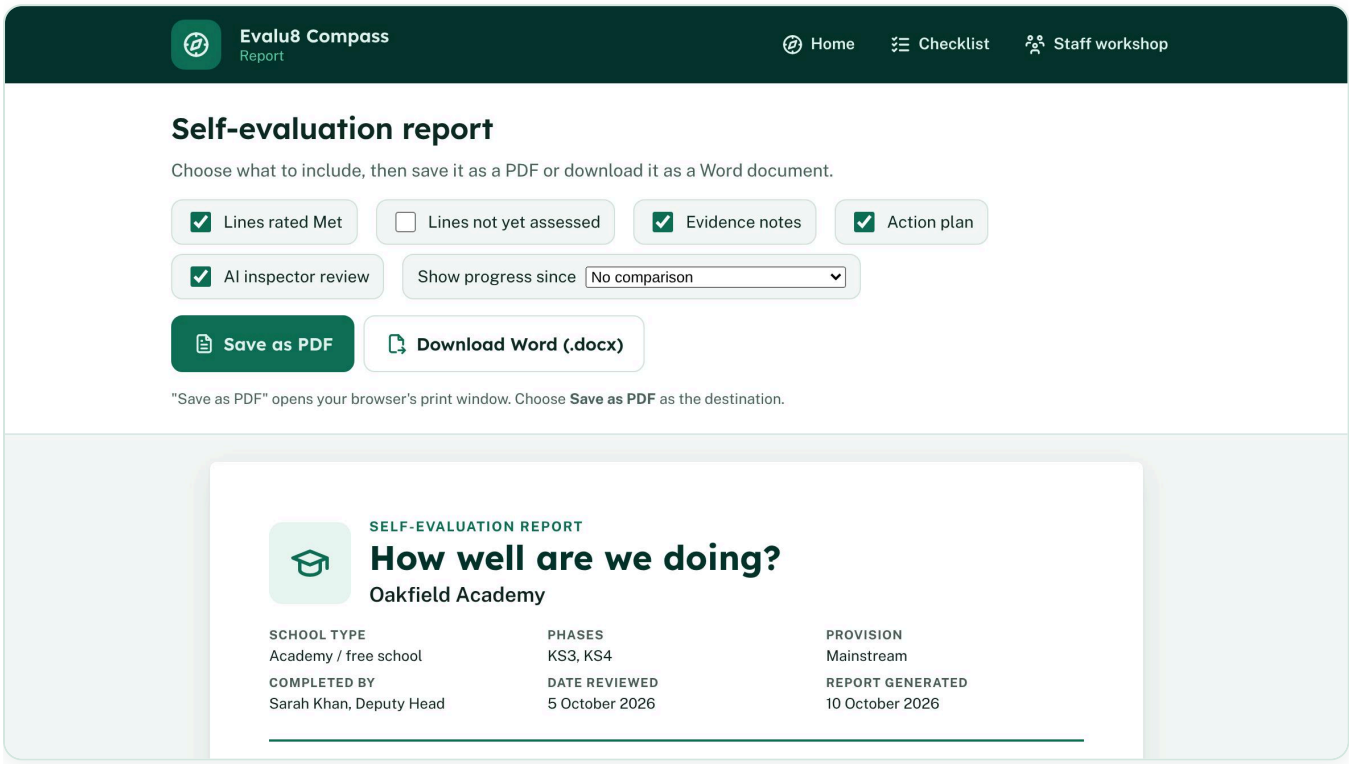
What's changed: % met then and now, lines improved or slipped, actions completed, and the change in each area.

Use **Report with this comparison** to add a "Progress since..." section to your report. It's strong evidence of improvement for governors and inspectors.

SECTION 8

Reports: PDF and Word

Choose **Report** on the checklist tabs for a formatted self-evaluation report with your logo.



Choose what to include, then save it.

- Tick what to include: lines rated Met, lines not yet assessed, evidence notes, the action plan, the AI review, and progress since a snapshot.
- `Save as PDF` opens your browser's print window: choose **Save as PDF** as the destination.
- `Download Word (.docx)` gives an editable document, ideal for governors' papers. It's also the most accessible version for screen-reader users.

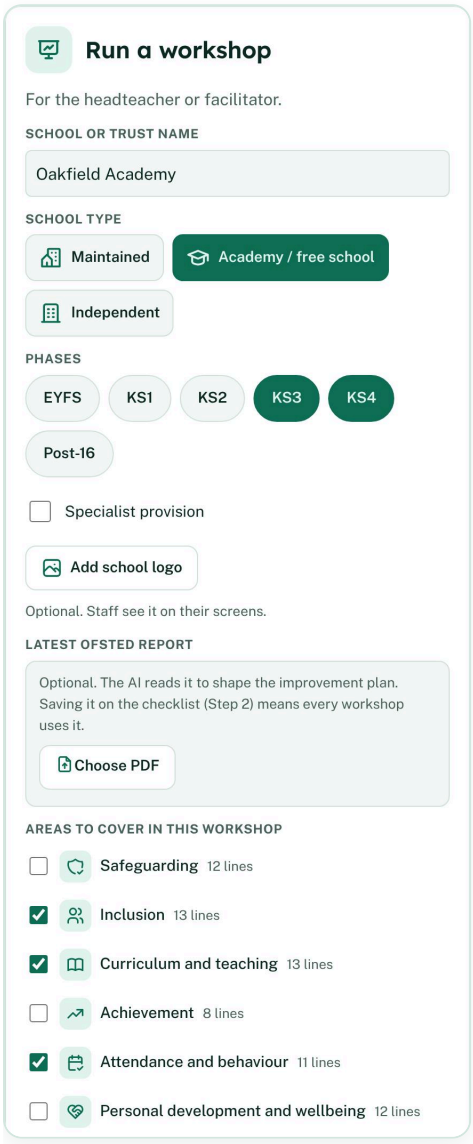
Each workshop has its own report too (section 9).

SECTION 9

Running a staff workshop

Staff rate the school anonymously on their own phones. You see the collated findings live, then turn them into an improvement plan.

Before: start the workshop



Starting a workshop.

1. Sign in with your access code, then open **Staff workshop**.
2. Under **Run a workshop**, check your school's name, type and phases. They're filled in from your checklist.
3. Under **Latest Ofsted report**, keep **Use your saved report** ticked, or choose a different PDF for this workshop.
4. Choose the **areas to cover**. Two or three areas suit a 45–60 minute session; the page shows how many lines that is.
5. Choose **Start workshop**.

Suggested 60-minute session

5 min	Why we're doing this. Answers are anonymous, there are no wrong answers, and no names in comments.
20 min	Staff join and rate the lines on their phones.
15 min	Share findings. Look at where staff agree and where views differ.
15 min	Discuss the splits and gaps; agree ratings together.
5 min	What happens next, and when staff will see the plan.

SECTION 9 CONTINUED

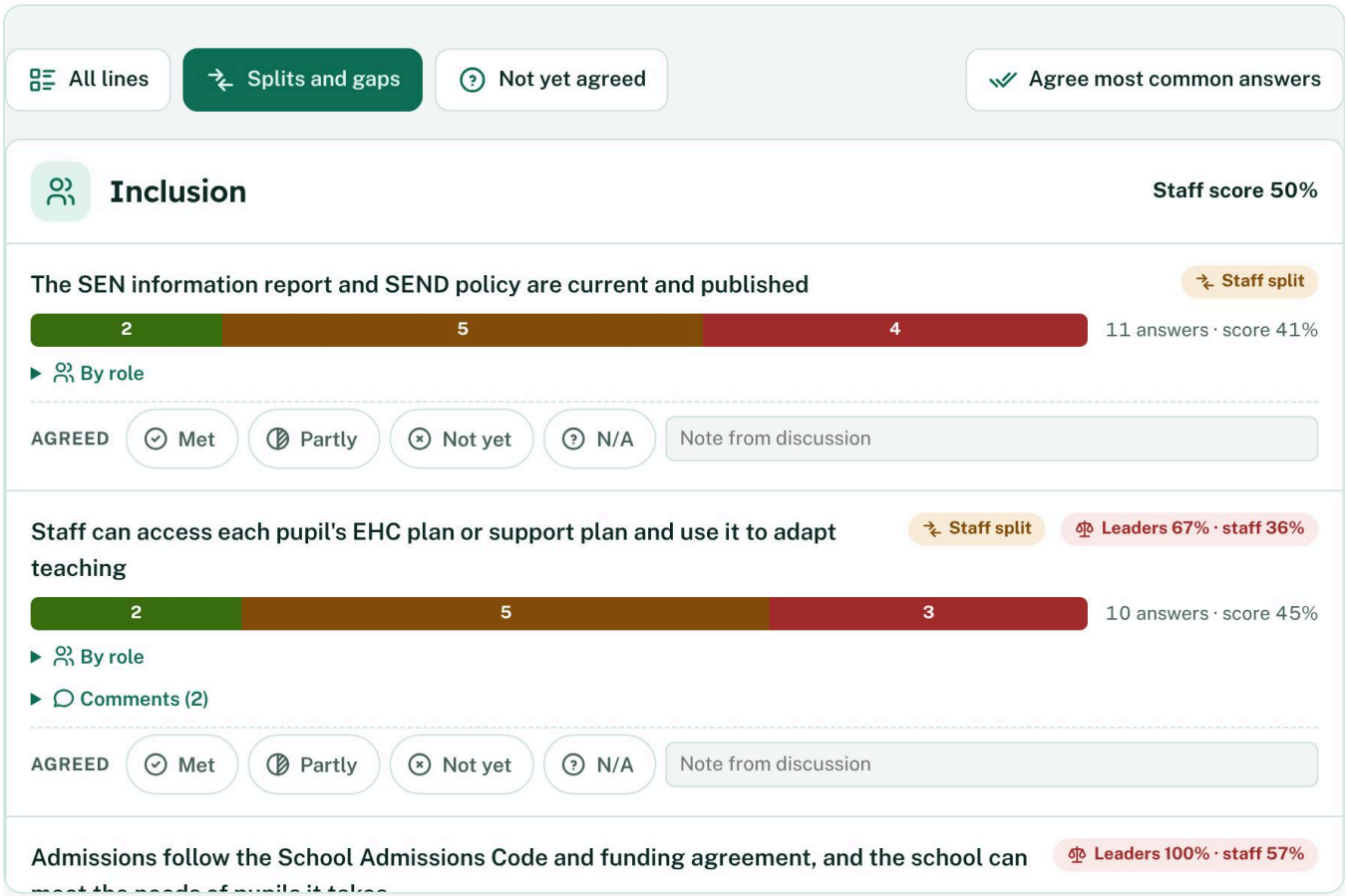
During: staff join and rate



Put this on the projector. Staff scan the QR code or go to the address and type the 6-character code. The counters show how many have joined and how much has been answered.

- **Share findings with staff** sends the collated results to everyone's phone when you're ready to discuss them. **Present mode** enlarges the findings for the projector.
- **Close responses** stops new answers when you've finished rating.
- **Copy facilitator link** lets you reopen the workshop on another device. Keep this link private: it gives full control of the workshop.

Live findings



Live findings, filtered to **Splits and gaps**. Coloured bars show how staff rated each line. "Staff split" means views are divided. "Leaders 100% · staff 25%" means senior leaders rated a line much higher than other staff did.

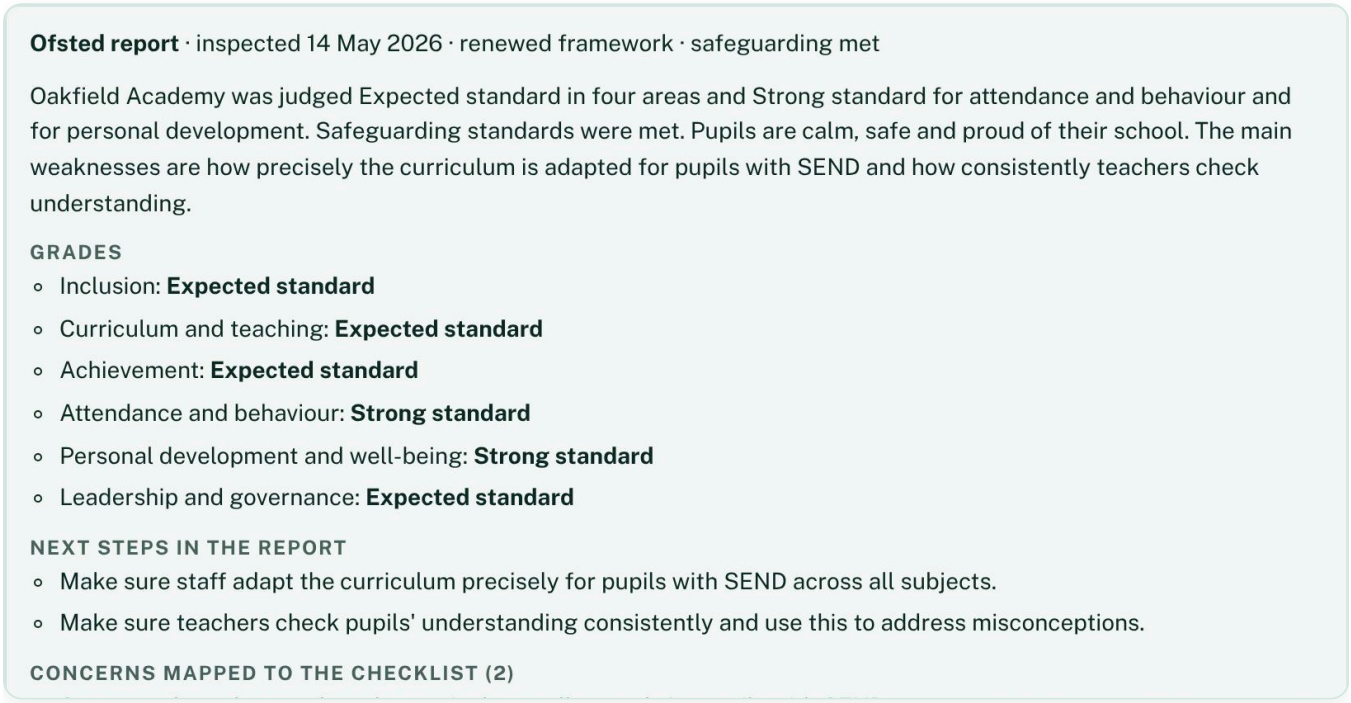
Anonymity is built in. No names or accounts. A role's breakdown (for example "Teaching assistants") is only shown when at least three people in that role have answered. Comments are shown without names.

SECTION 9 CONTINUED

After: agree ratings and generate the plan

1. **Agree ratings.** On each line choose the agreed rating after discussion, and add a note. **Agree most common answers** fills any you haven't agreed with the staff's most common answer: check these before relying on them.

2. Open the **Improvement plan** tab and complete the four steps:
   - **About your setting**: pupil numbers and needs, recent changes, current priorities. No names.
   - **Latest Ofsted report**: already filled in if you used your saved report. Otherwise **Choose PDF** (or paste the text), then **Read the report**.
   - **Summarise staff comments** groups comments into themes.
   - **Generate plan**.



Ofsted report · inspected 14 May 2026 · renewed framework · safeguarding met

Oakfield Academy was judged Expected standard in four areas and Strong standard for attendance and behaviour and for personal development. Safeguarding standards were met. Pupils are calm, safe and proud of their school. The main weaknesses are how precisely the curriculum is adapted for pupils with SEND and how consistently teachers check understanding.

GRADES

- Inclusion: **Expected standard**
- Curriculum and teaching: **Expected standard**
- Achievement: **Expected standard**
- Attendance and behaviour: **Strong standard**
- Personal development and well-being: **Strong standard**
- Leadership and governance: **Expected standard**

NEXT STEPS IN THE REPORT

- Make sure staff adapt the curriculum precisely for pupils with SEND across all subjects.
- Make sure teachers check pupils' understanding consistently and use this to address misconceptions.

CONCERNS MAPPED TO THE CHECKLIST (2)

The AI's reading of an Ofsted report: grades, safeguarding, next steps and concerns.

SECTION 9 CONTINUED

The improvement plan

The plan has **four priorities for the coming term**, led by your Ofsted report's next steps and where staff and leaders agree. Each priority is tagged with the evidence behind it (**ofsted**, **staff**, **agreed**, **context**) and has 2–3 actions with a lead, a date and the evidence each will produce. Policy and statutory gaps are listed separately as **compliance checks** to fix now. You also get quick wins and a short message to share with staff.

Oakfield is a calm, inclusive school judged Expected standard or better in every area. Staff and the Ofsted report agree that the next step is precise adaptation for pupils with SEND, supported by consistent checks on learning. This term's plan focuses on four priorities that build on existing strengths.

1 Precise adaptation for pupils with SEND in every subject

Curriculum and teaching OFSTED STAFF AGREED

The report's first next step, and the strongest theme in staff comments.

ACTION	LEAD	BY	EVIDENCE
Each department agrees two or three adaptations for its most common needs, using pupil profiles	SENCo with heads of department	October half-term	Adaptation notes in each scheme of work
Fortnightly coaching visits focused on adaptation, with quick feedback	Deputy head (teaching and learning)	December	Coaching log and follow-up visits

Success looks like: In any lesson, staff can show how a pupil's profile shapes their teaching.

Monitoring: SENCo reports to the head each half-term; SEND governor visits in December.

2 Consistent checks on understanding

Curriculum and teaching OFSTED STAFF

The report's second next step; staff ratings were split.

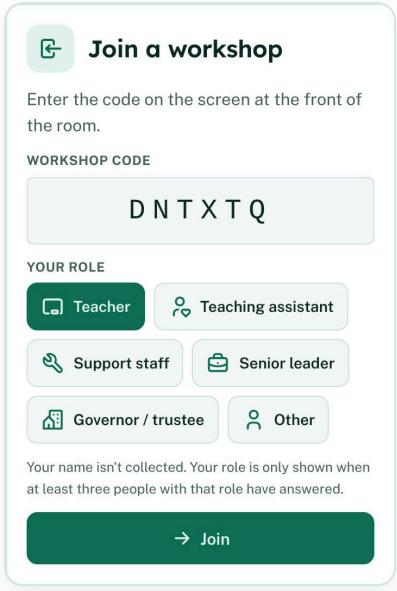
ACTION	LEAD	BY	EVIDENCE
Agree two low-workload routines (mini-whiteboards, hinge questions) for every lesson	Deputy head (teaching and learning)	November	Agreed routines and CPD record
Book looks check that misconceptions are picked up and addressed	Heads of department	December	Book-look summaries

An example plan. It's a draft for the headteacher to edit and adopt.

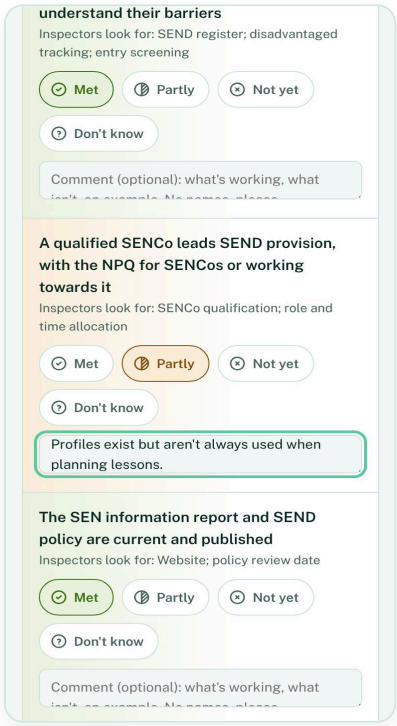
Then

- **Share plan with staff** shows the priorities and your message on staff phones.
- **Copy plan** copies it as text for your school development plan.
- On the **Export** tab, **Send to our checklist** adds the agreed ratings (with the staff split as an evidence note) and the plan's actions to your school's checklist and action plan.
- The **Workshop report** gives participation, findings, where views differ, themes, the Ofsted reading and the plan, as PDF or Word.

Joining a staff workshop



Joining on a phone.



Rating lines, with an optional comment.

It takes about 20 minutes, and it's anonymous.

1. On your phone, scan the QR code on the screen, or go to **evalu8compass.app** and type the **6-character code**.
2. Choose your role: teacher, teaching assistant, support staff, senior leader, governor/trustee or other.
3. Choose **Join**. No name, email or account is needed.
4. For each line choose Met Partly Not yet or Don't know, from your own experience.
5. Add a comment if you like: what's working, what isn't, an example.

Your answers are anonymous. Your role is only shown when at least three people with that role have answered.

Please don't name pupils or colleagues in comments. Describe what happens, not who.

Answers save as you go. You can change them until the facilitator closes responses. When findings or the plan are shared, they appear on your phone.

SECTION 11

Your data and privacy

- **Your school controls its information.** Only people with your school's access code can see your self-evaluation, action plan and snapshots.
- **Workshops are anonymous.** Staff give a role only. Exports and reports contain collated findings, never individual responses.
- **AI is optional** and runs only when someone presses an AI button. The AI provider (Anthropic) doesn't train on your information and deletes it within 30 days.
- **No advertising, analytics or tracking.** Everything runs from our own server over an encrypted connection, with daily encrypted backups.
- **Retention:** workshops are deleted 90 days after they were last used. Your school's saved work is kept while you have access, then deleted. Ask us at any time to delete it sooner.

For your data protection officer, the **DPIA information for schools** page at evalu8compass.app/dpia.html sets out how the service works, the risks and how they're reduced. See also the privacy notice, terms and accessibility statement, linked at the foot of every page.

⚠ **On a shared computer,** sign out when you've finished. A copy of your work is kept in that browser for offline use until you clear the site's data.

SECTION 12

Questions and help

IF…	THEN…
My access code "isn't recognised"	Check for typing mistakes (O and 0, I and 1 aren't used). If it still fails it may have expired: email support@evalu8compass.app.
The badge says **Offline**	Keep working: changes are saved on your device and sent when the connection returns.
The badge says **Signed out**	Your 30-day sign-in has ended or the code was replaced. Choose **Sign in again**; nothing on the device is lost.
"This device has an earlier copy"	Your work was once saved only in this browser. Keep the shared copy unless you know this device has the newer work.
A colleague's change appeared while I was typing	That's expected. Your cursor stays where it was, and both changes are kept.
AI says the allowance is used up	You'll get built-in suggestions until the 1st of next month. Ask us if you need more.
Staff see "Results haven't been shared yet"	The facilitator turns on **Share findings with staff** when ready.
I closed the workshop page	Open **Staff workshop** on the same device and choose it under **Your recent workshops**, or use the facilitator link you copied.
Something doesn't work or isn't clear	Email **support@evalu8compass.app** with the page and what happened.

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